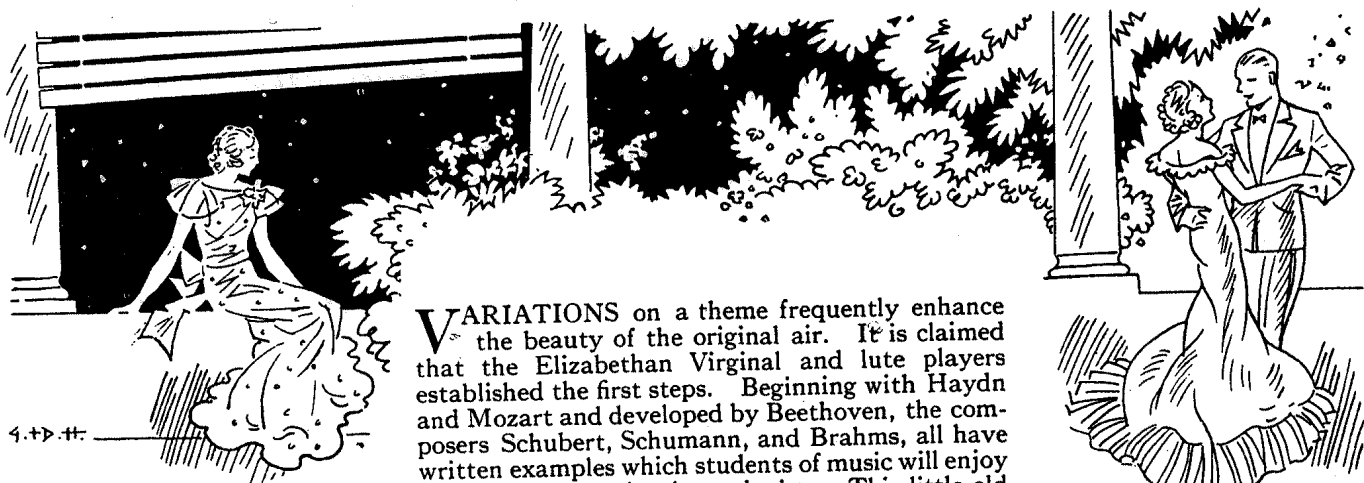




VARIATIONS on a theme frequently enhance the beauty of the original air. It is claimed that the Elizabethan Virginal and lute players established the first steps. Beginning with Haydn and Mozart and developed by Beethoven, the composers Schubert, Schumann, and Brahms, all have written examples which students of music will enjoy as they progress in piano playing. This little old time waltz, written many years ago by an American composer of teaching pieces exemplifies the popularity of variations of that period.

Starlight Waltz

C. S. Brainard

Tempo di Valse

The musical score for "Starlight Waltz" is written for piano. It features a treble and bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. The tempo is marked "Tempo di Valse". The score is divided into three systems. The first system begins with a mezzo-forte (mf) dynamic. The melody in the treble clef is accompanied by chords in the bass clef. The second system continues the piece, and the third system concludes with a forte (f) dynamic. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, slurs, and fingerings.

First system of musical notation. The treble clef staff contains a sequence of chords and single notes with fingerings: 5 3, 3 1, 5 3, 2 1, and 3 1. The bass clef staff contains a sequence of chords. The key signature has one sharp (F#).

Second system of musical notation. The treble clef staff contains a sequence of chords and single notes with fingerings: 4 2, 5 3, 5 3, and 1 2. The bass clef staff contains a sequence of chords. The word "Fine" is written at the end of the system. The key signature has one sharp (F#).

Third system of musical notation. The treble clef staff contains a sequence of chords and single notes with fingerings: 5 3, 4 2, 4 2, 5 3, and 2 1. The bass clef staff contains a sequence of chords. A dynamic marking *f* (forte) is present at the beginning of the system. The key signature has one sharp (F#).

Fourth system of musical notation. The treble clef staff contains a sequence of chords and single notes with fingerings: 5 3, 4 2, and 2 1. The bass clef staff contains a sequence of chords. The key signature has one sharp (F#).

1 *mf* 3 1 2 1 4 1 2 1 1 2 4 5

3 1 2 3 5 3 3 1 2 1 4 1 2 1

1 2 4 3 2 1 1 2 3

f 3 4 4 2 1 2 4 4 2 2 1

5 3 4 4 2 1 2 4 4 2 2 1

D. C. al Fine

Set a good tempo and keep it intact.

A waltz in $\frac{3}{8}$ time is played considerably faster than one in $\frac{3}{4}$.

Note the accent on the second beat which occurs very frequently.

The last Variation may require separate practise for the right hand. The groups of semiquavers should be cleanly fingered and rolled off at the end of each phrased group.

Pedal only where marked.